The `--merge` option to `makemigrations` operates on files with the same numbers, producing a new migration script named with the next number. The new script has no operations but depends on the two conflicting ones. This ensures future migration scripts are dependent on both files. Figure 10.1 illustrates this resolution.

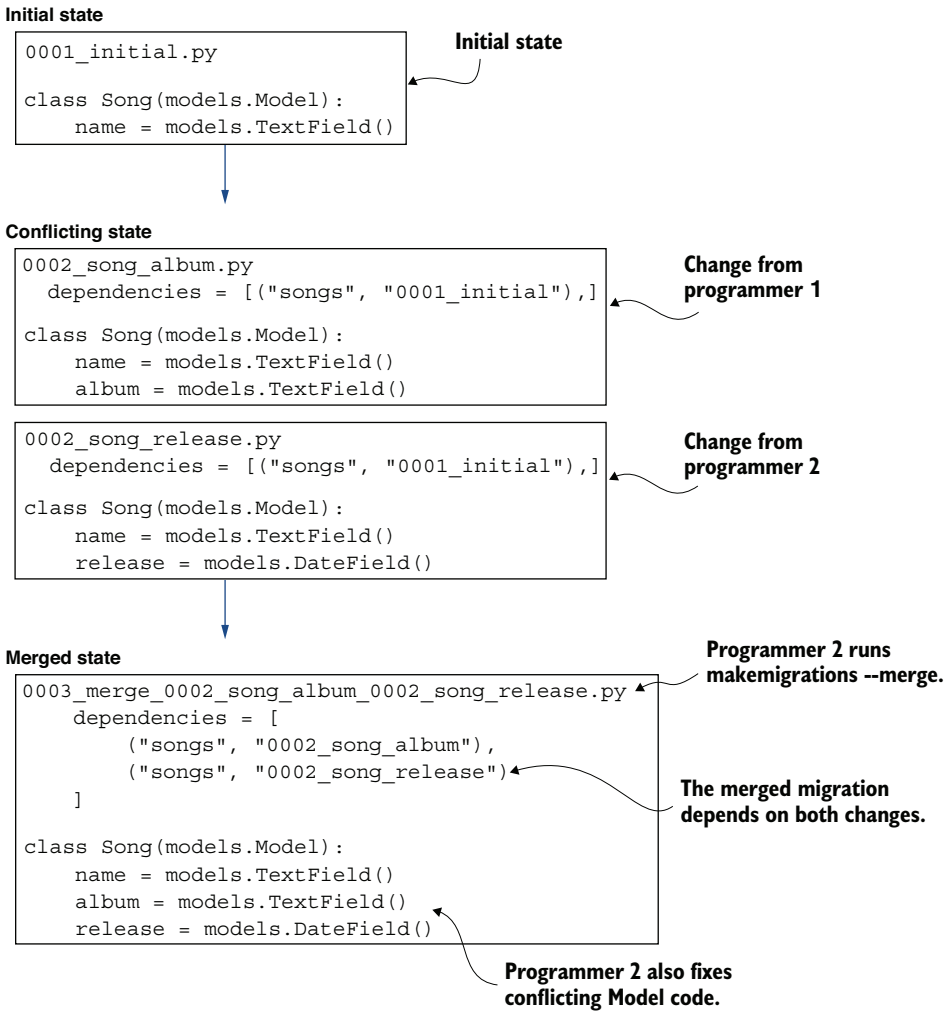


Figure 10.1 Dealing with a merge conflict containing migration scripts

If you go back and look at the output of `squashmigrations`, you'll notice it contains `Optimizing...`. During the squashing process, Django examines the operations and attempts to reduce the number of them, if possible. For example, if you are squashing together migrations that both create a new table and later add fields to that table,